

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Court of Protection Paralegal role at your client firm appeals to me because the work sits at the intersection of legal procedure and direct support for vulnerable individuals, which matches both my practical experience and where I want to develop. My background in case preparation, client-facing advice and procedural document management across disputes and welfare matters gives me a grounding that transfers directly to Court of Protection work.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I advise clients on welfare benefits, housing and family matters, many of whom are in difficult personal circumstances. I take detailed factual statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence, prepare document schedules and manage files from instruction through to submission. Working with vulnerable clients has required me to translate complex statutory rules into plain guidance under time pressure, which is precisely the kind of client-facing judgment and file management that Court of Protection work demands.

During my year at BCLP, I developed the procedural and organisational skills that underpin paralegal work in a court-facing environment. In the international arbitration team, I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline. I coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions across a large evidence set and helped ensure on-time submission of the Claimant's memorial. In the real estate disputes team, I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines. Both rotations gave me direct experience of the kind of structured case-file management and deadline tracking that Court of Protection matters require.

What draws me specifically to Court of Protection work is the combination of procedural rigour and the real-world impact each matter has on the person at the centre of it. My experience at Citizens Advice has given me a clear sense of how much careful case preparation matters when clients are in vulnerable situations, and I want to build on that in a firm environment where that work is the core focus. A firm recommended in The Legal 500 and operating across a broad range of practice areas offers the kind of institutional structure and depth of work where I can develop properly in this specialism.

I am available immediately and based in London.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva